Owen Barstad

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Education

The University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA *Anticipated December 2026*
B.S., Earth and Planetary Science
GIS Certificate

Work Experience

Research Assistant | University of Iowa | Iowa City, IA *Sept 2024 – Present*

- Research Assistant under Dr. McClelland/Dr. Finzel in the Geochronology Laboratory.
- Multi-Step procedure of processing rock samples to collect zircons and heavy minerals for radiometric dating and provenance studies.
- Completed required online/in-person safety training to work in a lab setting and operate heavy machinery, fume hoods and handling necessary chemicals.
- Responsible for working independently, logging my own hours, maintaining the space and equipment after every use, as well as organizing and communicating my data in a concise manner.
- Proficient in heavy mineral separation procedures and analyzing mounts using a Scanning Electron Microscope.

Camp Counselor | John Knox Ranch | Fischer, TX *Summer 2021, 2022, 2024*

- Care for children ranging in ages from 6-16 in a rugged outdoor environment for up to 14 days.
- Responsible for creating team building exercises, leading games, and guiding children on our day to activities such as hiking, camping, fishing, canoeing, etc.
- Communicating with parents at pick-up/drop-off and answering any questions/concerns of theirs about the camp or child.
- Work with co-counselors/upper leadership team to plan and create activities for children during their stay at camp.

Server | Hamburg Inn No. 2 | Iowa City, IA *Sept 2022 – Sept 2024*

- Interact with customers who come into the diner, making sure they are comfortable and their needs are accommodated.
- Take food orders and run food out, ensuring the customer has everything they need to enjoy their meal and dining experience.
- Completing an opening/closing list each shift which includes cleaning/organizing/preparing the dining area, bathrooms, and server station while organizing/stocking front of house.

College Activities

Student Ambassador | University of Iowa: SEES Dept. | Iowa City, IA *Present*

- Representing the School of Earth, Environment and Sustainability by visiting with propective students, travelling to surroudning schools to share information about the school, attending alumni visit days, and helping with department events.

Prairie Research | University of Iowa: SEES Dept. | Iowa City, IA *Present*

- Currently working under Dr. Swanson and am monitoring soil moisture content in specific plots of Ashton Prairie to help analyze water drainage patterns.
- Experience using equipment such as a Trimble for GPS location, TEROS12 soil moisture probes, ProDSS Water Quality Monitor, Infiltrometer for water drainage and a Photometer for measuring contaminants in water.

GeoChron Research | University of Arizona | Tucson, AZ *Feb 16th – Feb 22nd 2025*

- Attended the Arizona LaserChron center to process zircon samples and conduct research over the course of a week under my supervisor.
- Operated with Mass Spectrometers and Chromium Software, picking through and preparing the sample before processing.
- Gained experience operating excel to perform calculations and organize sample data.

Research thesis | University of Iowa | Iowa City, IA *In-Progress*

- Studying igneous zircon geochronology in the southwestern montana foreland basin using zircon populations obtained from a tuff deposit located in the Lower Calcareous unit of the Lower Cretaceous Kootenai formation.
- Advisors: Dr. Bill McClelland, Dr. Emily Finzel, Dr. Jeffrey Dorale

Courses

- Geologic Field Methods *Summer 2024*
- Geologic Field Analysis *Summer 2025*